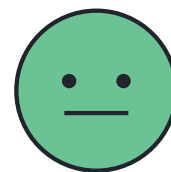
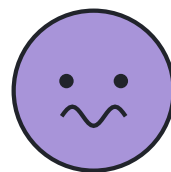
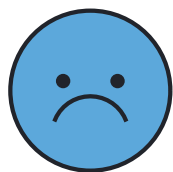


CALM & CONFIDENT SEL SERIES



Brave Feelings

A Coping Skills Activity Book for Kids - Facing Worry, Fear & Hard Days With Courage

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 5-17 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

Welcome! This book helps kids and teens understand big feelings and learn calm, kind ways to handle them. Feelings are not good or bad - they are messengers. This book builds the skills to listen to them and choose what to do next.

Every page is printable and reproducible for your home or classroom. Go at the reader's pace, and celebrate effort more than 'right answers.'

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Do the activities alongside the child when you can - your calm helps them feel safe.
- ☐ Name feelings out loud together; naming a feeling helps shrink it.
- ☐ Never punish a feeling. Coach the choice that comes after it.
- ☐ Revisit favorite pages often - skills grow with practice, not one-time reading.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



Grows With the Reader (Ages 5-17)

This book is built for a wide range of ages. Younger children can color, trace, and point to feelings faces. Older kids and teens can use the same pages for journaling, deeper reflection, and building real coping plans.

Younger (about 5-9)

- ☐ Color the feelings faces and calm-down pictures.
- ☐ Trace the calming words and short affirmations.
- ☐ Do the breathing shapes with a grown-up.

Older kids & teens (about 10-17)

- ☐ Write in the journal and reflection spaces.
- ☐ Work through the 'What would you do?' scenarios.
- ☐ Build and personalize your own coping toolkit and calm-down plan.

What's Inside



- 1 Getting to Know Feelings
- 2 Brave vs. Scared
- 3 Coping Skills
- 4 Facing Worries
- 5 Making Calm Choices
- 6 Calm & Reflect
- 7 My Plan
- 8 Gratitude



Part 1: Getting to Know Feelings

Every feeling has a name and a message.

Faces We Make



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



Happy



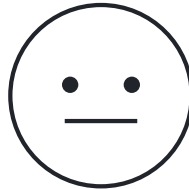
Sad



Angry



Worried



Calm

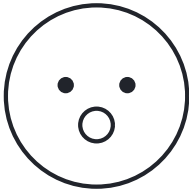


Excited

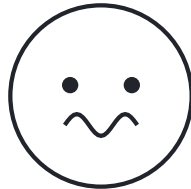
More Feelings We Have



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



Surprised



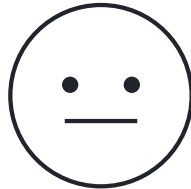
Nervous



Lonely



Proud



Relaxed



Frustrated

MATCH

Match the Feeling to What Helps



Draw a line from each feeling to one thing that can help.

● Angry

get a hug ●

● Worried

share the good news ●

● Sad

talk to someone ●

● Excited

take deep breaths ●



My Feelings Thermometer

A feelings thermometer shows how BIG a feeling is. Green is calm and okay. Yellow is starting to bubble. Red is a very big feeling. Knowing our level helps us pick the right calm-down tool.



RED - Big feeling



YELLOW - Getting bigger



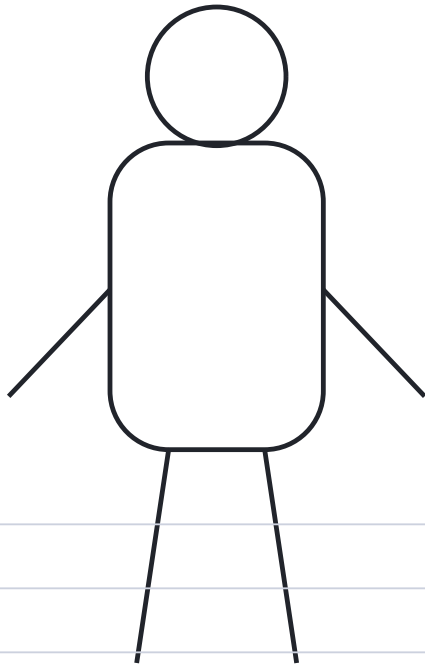
GREEN - Calm & okay

What can I do at each level? Write above.



Where Do I Feel It?

Big feelings live in our bodies too. Anger might feel hot in your chest. Worry might feel like butterflies in your tummy. Color or mark where you feel your feelings.



Draw or color:

- Hot / angry feelings
- Fluttery / worried feelings
- Heavy / sad feelings
- Calm / good feelings

Today my body feels...

My Feelings Today



● A feeling I felt today was...

● It showed up in my body like this...

● What I did about it was...



Part 2: Brave vs. Scared

Brave doesn't mean not scared - it means going on anyway.



What Does Brave Really Mean?

Being brave doesn't mean you never feel scared or worried. Brave means feeling the fear AND doing the hard thing anyway - sometimes in tiny steps. Everyone feels afraid sometimes. Courage is a skill you can grow.

Worry vs. real danger

Sometimes our worry alarm goes off even when we're safe - like a smoke alarm beeping at burnt toast. Learning to check 'Am I really in danger, or is this a worry alarm?' helps us feel braver.

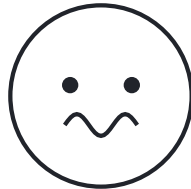
Faces of Worry & Courage



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



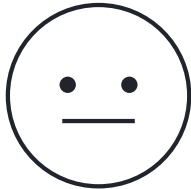
Worried



Nervous



Scared



Calm



Brave



Proud

My Worry Thermometer



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GREEN - Calm & okay

What can I do at each level? Write above.



Part 3: Coping Skills

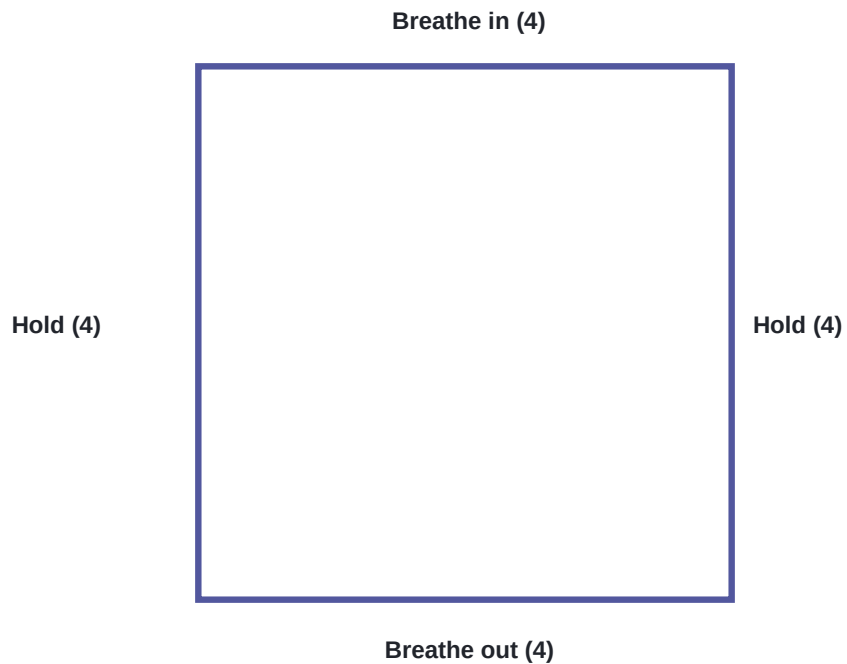
Tools for worry, fear, and hard days.



Square (Box) Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Box Breathing



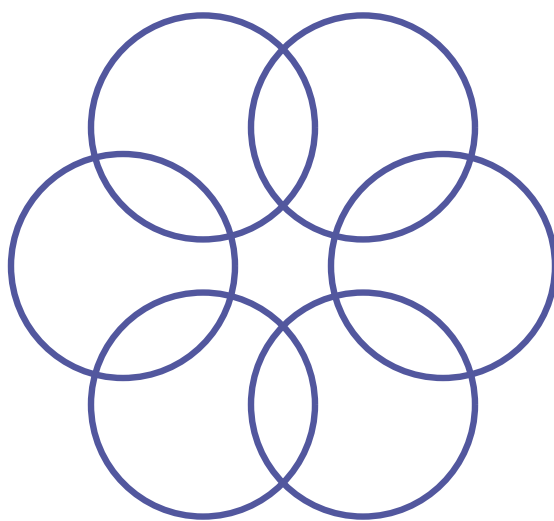
1. Trace up one side as you breathe IN for 4.
2. Trace across the top as you HOLD for 4.
3. Trace down as you breathe OUT for 4.
4. Trace across the bottom as you HOLD for 4.
5. Repeat 3-5 times until you feel calmer.



Flower & Candle Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Flower Breathing



1. Pretend to smell a flower - breathe IN through your nose.
2. Pretend to cool soup or blow a candle - breathe OUT slowly through your mouth.
3. Trace each petal as you breathe.
4. Notice your shoulders drop as you relax.

Brave Coping Cards



These are calm-down tools. Try each one. Circle the ones that work best for YOU, then cut them out or copy them for your calm corner.

1 Name the Worry

Say exactly what you're worried about.

2 Check the Facts

Ask: is this a real danger or a worry alarm?

3 Brave Step

Break it into one tiny step you can do.

4 Worry Time

Save worries for a set 10-minute 'worry time.'

5 Talk It Out

Share the worry with a safe person.

6 Brave Self-Talk

Say: 'I can do hard things.'

Brave Words



Trace the calming words. Then say them out loud.

I can do hard things.

I am braver than my worry.

One small step.

Now write your own calming words:



My Worry Ladder

A worry ladder breaks a scary thing into small steps, from easiest at the bottom to hardest at the top. You climb one rung at a time.

Something I want to feel braver about:

Top step (hardest):

Middle step:

Middle step:

First step (easiest):



Part 3: Making Calm Choices

Feelings happen to us - choices are up to us.



What Would You Do? (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1 You feel scared to try something new, like a class or a sport.**

What could you do?

- 2 You have a worry that keeps coming back at bedtime.**

What could you do?

- 3 You feel afraid to ask for help.**

What could you do?



What Would You Do? (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You're anxious about a big test or performance.

What could you do?

2 You feel nervous about a hard conversation.

What could you do?

3 A worry is making it hard to focus or sleep.

What could you do?



My Calm Choice Checklist

Before I react, I can check this list. Tick the ones you want to remember.

- ☐ I take a breath before I speak or act.
- ☐ I name what I'm feeling.
- ☐ I ask myself: will this help or hurt?
- ☐ I use a calm-down tool if the feeling is big.
- ☐ I ask for help if I need it.
- ☐ I try again - mistakes are okay.

A Time I Made a Calm Choice



- Describe a time you handled a big feeling well.

- What did you do? How did it turn out?

- What will you try next time?



Part 4: Calm & Reflect

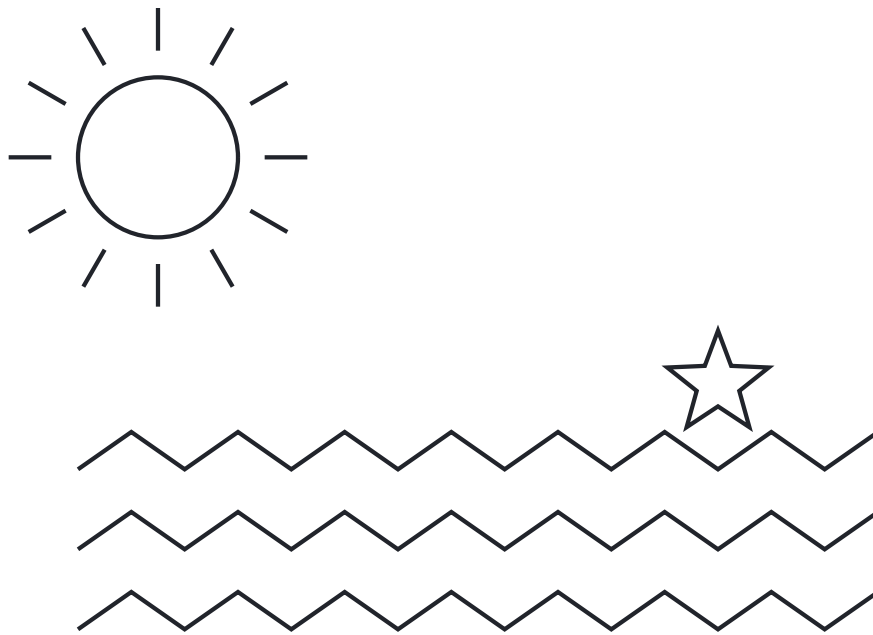
Rest your mind and notice the good.

COLOR

Calm Beach



A quiet place by the gentle sea



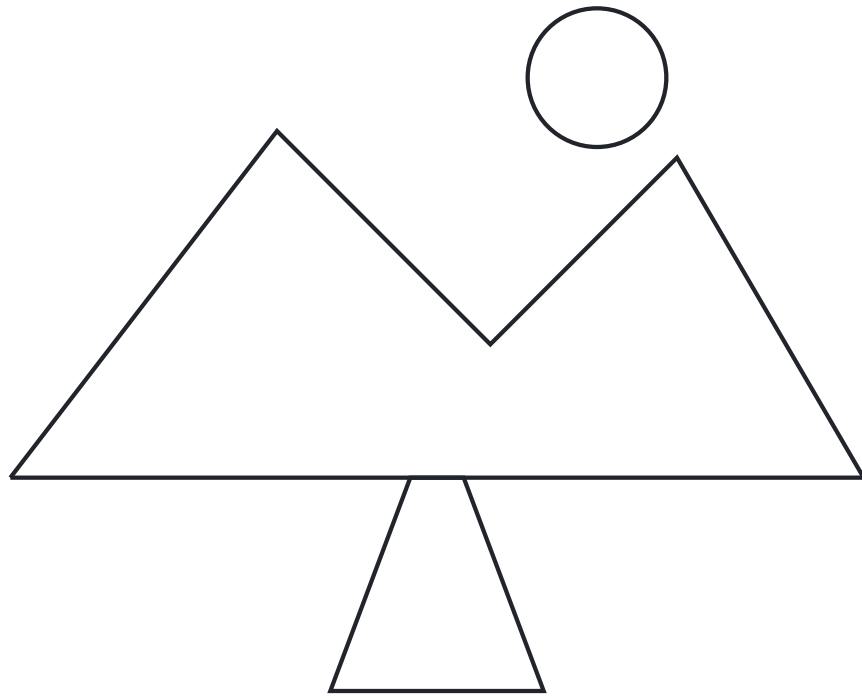
Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Peaceful Mountains



Breathe in the fresh mountain air



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

COLOR

Cozy Corner



A safe, comfy place to rest



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

My Calm Place



- Describe or draw a place where you feel calm.

- What do you see, hear, and feel there?

Draw your calm place:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for drawing a calm place.



Part 5: My Practice Week

Practice makes calm feel natural.



Monday & Tuesday

Monday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Tuesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:



Wednesday & Thursday

Wednesday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Thursday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Friday & Weekend



Friday



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

Weekend



good



calm



worried



sad



angry

One thing that helped me today:

My Practice Week Review



● Which calm-down tool did I use the most?

● Which tool worked best for me?

● What do I want to keep practicing next week?



My Top Calm-Down Tools

Out of everything you tried, which tools help YOU most? Write your personal top tools so you remember them when a big feeling shows up.

1

2

3

4

5

When I feel calm, I can help others by...



How Far I've Come

Look how much you've learned! Tick everything you can do now (or are practicing).

- ☐ I can name my feelings.
- ☐ I can notice feelings in my body.
- ☐ I know my warning signs for big feelings.
- ☐ I have calm-down tools I can use.
- ☐ I can make calmer choices.
- ☐ I can ask for help when I need it.
- ☐ I can be kind to myself when things are hard.



My Personal Calm-Down Plan

This is YOUR plan for big feelings. Fill it in and keep it somewhere you'll see it. You can update it any time as you learn what helps.

When I notice a big feeling, my body signal is...

Three calm-down tools I will try first are...

A safe person I can talk to is...

Words I can say to myself are...

A calm place I can go is...



Good Things & Gratitude

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

Letter to Myself



- Write a kind letter to yourself for a day you feel a big feeling.

- What do you want to remember?

- What would you tell a friend feeling the same way?

My Growing Skills



● One feeling I understand better now is...

● One thing I can do when it gets big is...

● I feel proud that I can...

Slowing Down My Mind



● When my mind feels busy, I can...

● A quiet thing I enjoy is...

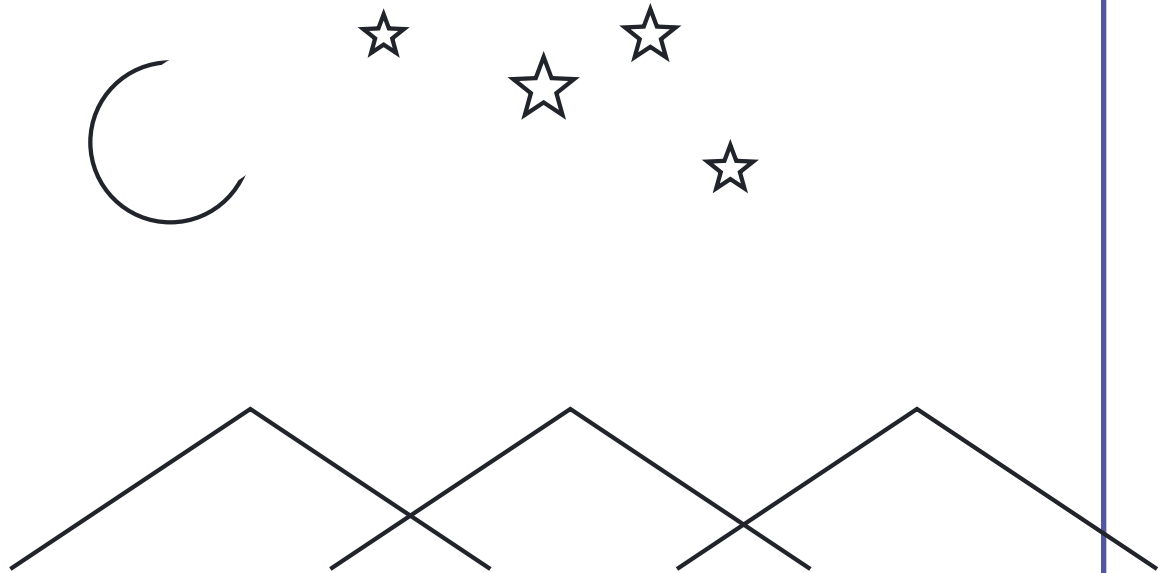
● One slow, calm thing I will do today is...

COLOR

Starry Night



A peaceful, starry sky to unwind under



Color it in with calm colors that feel good to you.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page below the header.

My Notes & Doodles



A series of horizontal lines for writing notes, spanning the width of the page.